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uOttawa

Comparative Conspiracy Research Survey (CCRS)

– Online Survey Questionnaire –

Generic Survey

Refer to Codebook for Country-Specific Items

Version 1.0

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BLOCK 1: FILTER QUESTION

Before we begin, please answer the following question:

Q1. Are you a citizen or permanent resident of [country]?

( ) Yes
( ) No

BLOCK 2: INTRODUCTION AND CONSENT

You are invited to participate in a survey. Before accepting to take part, please read the following information which outlines the conditions related to your participation. Once you are done reading the document, press "yes" to accept the terms and carry on with the survey and "no" if you do not wish to proceed. Clicking "yes" will be considered as your informed consent to participate in the survey.

This project seeks to gather information regarding citizens' political opinions on various topics. We are trying to understand your opinion on certain policies and what you think is important in politics. Your participation will be completely anonymous, and it will be impossible to identify participants. The questionnaire should take roughly 15 minutes to complete.

There are no foreseeable risks or advantages associated with participating in this survey.

Participants are not to provide their names or any information that could help identify them. The only personal information to be collected is demographics such as age and gender. It will therefore be impossible for anyone to identify participants. Participants will not be identifiable.

Your participation is entirely voluntary and you are allowed to end your participation at any time. If you decide to end your participation, your data may not be used and will be destroyed and you will not be remunerated.

Pressing the "Yes" button (below) will be interpreted as providing consent for participation in this survey. It will also be interpreted as indicating that you: realize that you are not required to participate if you so choose, are free to withdraw from the study at any point during the completion of the survey, and freely consent to participate in this survey.

Q2. Do you consent to participate in this survey?

( ) Yes
( ) No

BLOCK 3: SOCIODEMOGRAPHICS

We will begin by asking you a series of demographic questions. It is important that you answer these questions accurately.

Q3. How old are you?
(write-in answer)

Q4. How do you describe yourself?
( ) Male
( ) Female
( ) Non-binary / third gender
( ) Prefer to self-describe: _____
( ) Prefer not to say

Q5. In which province or territory do you currently reside?
(dropdown menu)

Q6. Country-specific education level question (see codebook)

Q7. How urban or rural is your place of residence?
( ) A big city
( ) A suburb or outskirt of a big city
( ) A town or a small city
( ) A village
( ) The countryside
( ) Don't know / prefer not to say

Q8. Were you born in [country]?
( ) Yes
( ) No
( ) Don't know / prefer not to answer

Q9. What was your total household income before taxes during the past 12 months?
( ) Less than $25,000
( ) $25,000 – $49,999
( ) $50,000 – $74,999
( ) $75,000 – $99,999
( ) $100,000 – $149,999
( ) $150,000 or more
( ) Prefer not to say

Q10. Financially-speaking, in your country, would you say you are a part of the lower-class, middle-class, or the upper-class?
( ) Lower class
( ) Middle class

( ) Upper class
( ) Don’t know / prefer not to answer

Q11. What is your employment status? Are you currently…
( ) Working for pay full-time
( ) Working for pay part-time
( ) Self-employed (with or without employees)
( ) Retired
( ) Unemployed / looking for work
( ) Student
( ) Caring for a family member
( ) Disabled
( ) Student and working for pay
( ) Retired and working for pay
( ) Other (please specify): _____
( ) Don’t know / prefer not to answer

Q12. To what ethnic or cultural group(s) do you belong? (dropdown menu)
( ) White
( ) South Asian
( ) Chinese
( ) Black
( ) Filipino
( ) Latin American
( ) Arab
( ) Southeast Asian (e.g., Vietnamese, Cambodian, Malaysian, Laotian, etc.)
( ) West Asian (e.g., Iranian, Afghan, etc.)
( ) Korean
( ) Japanese
( ) Other (please specify): _____
( ) Don’t know / prefer not to answer

BLOCK 4: IDEOLOGY, INTEREST, AND PARTICIPATION[1, 2]

Now, we will ask you several questions regarding your political opinions and attitudes. It is important that you answer as truthfully as possible. Do not stay stuck on any given question, your first feeling is generally best.

Q13. In politics people sometimes talk of left and right. Where would you place yourself on a scale from 0 to 10 where 0 means the left and 10 means the right?

Left										Right
(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)

Q14. How interested are you in politics?

No at all interested										Very interested
(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)

Q15. Country-specific political party identification item (see codebook).

Q16. In any election, some people are not able to vote because they are sick or busy, or for some other reason. Others do not want to vote. What about you, did you vote in the [last first order country] election?

( ) Yes
( ) No
( ) Don't know / prefer not to answer

Q17. Party vote choice (country-specific)

Q18. Now, thinking of the **next** election, would you say you are:

( ) Unlikely to vote
( ) Likely to vote
( ) Certain to vote
( ) Not eligible to vote
( ) Don't know / prefer not to answer

[1] Questions in this block are presented to participants in a randomized order.
[2] Blocks 4 to 13 will be presented to participants in a randomized order.

Q19. On a scale from 0 (the least extent) to 10 (the greatest extent), in your opinion, to what extent should:

	Least extent										Greatest extent
The government be involved in the redistribution of wealth from the wealthy to the poor.	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)
The government provide gas and food subsidies.	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)
Schools be focused on instilling discipline in students.	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)
The government be involved in regulating the sexual conduct of individuals.	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)
Immigration to the country be more tightly restricted.	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)

BLOCK 5: SATISFACTION WITH DEMOCRACY AND TRUST[3]

Q20. How satisfied are you with the performance of the federal government over the past 12 months?

Not satisfied at all										Very satisfied
(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)

Q21. How satisfied are you with the way democracy works in [country]?

Not satisfied at all										Very satisfied
(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)

Q22. Generally speaking, would you say that most people can be trusted or that you need to be very careful in dealing with people?

( ) Most people can be trusted
( ) Need to be very careful
( ) Don't know / prefer not to answer

Q23. For the following institutions and groups of individuals, could you indicate how much trust you have in them?

	No trust at all										A lot of trust
Government	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)
Politicians	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)
Political parties	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)
Elections	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)
Courts	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)
Independent Experts	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)
Journalists	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)

[3] Questions in this block are presented to participants in a randomized order.

Q24. On a scale from 0 (no influence) to 10 (most influence), how much influence do you believe each of the following groups have over policy decisions in Canada:

	Not influential										Highly influential
Bureaucrats	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)
Business leaders	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)
Journalists	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)
Military officers	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)
Politicians	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)
Religious leaders	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)
Scientists	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)
The wealthy	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)
University professors	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)

Q25. In this survey, we have referred to the elites. In your opinion, which of the following groups can generally be considered as among the elites in your society? (choose all of the groups that apply)

[ ] Business leaders
[ ] Journalists
[ ] Military officers
[ ] Politicians
[ ] Religious leaders
[ ] Scientists
[ ] The wealthy
[ ] University professors
[ ] Other: _____

Q26. On a scale from 0 to 10, how much trust do you have in each of the following groups:

	No trust										Complete trust
Bureaucrats	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)

Business leaders	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)
Journalists	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)
Military officers	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)
Politicians	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)
Religious leaders	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)
Scientists	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)
The wealthy	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)
University professors	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)

Q27. On a scale from 0 (least trust) to 10 (most trust), how much trust do you have in scientists to:

	No trust										Complete trust
Competently execute their research	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)
Create knowledge that is unbiased	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)
Generate findings that are useful	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)
Inform the public on important issues	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)
Provide sound advice to government officials	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)

Q28. On a scale from 0 (no trust) to 10 (complete trust), how much trust do you have in each of the following organizations:

	No trust										Complete trust
Amnesty International	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)

Greenpeace	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)
International Monetary Fund	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)
NATO	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)
United Nations	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)
World Bank	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)
World Health Organization	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)

BLOCK 6: POPULIST ATTITUDES

Q29.[4] On a scale from 1 to 5, how much do you agree or disagree with each of the following statements?

	Very much disagree					Very much agree
The politicians in the [country upper house] need to follow the will of the people.	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)
The people, and not politicians, should make our most important policy decisions.	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)
The political differences between the elite and the people are larger than the differences among the people.	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)
I would rather be represented by a citizen than by a specialized politician.	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)
Elected officials talk too much and take too little action.	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)
Politics is ultimately a struggle between good and evil.	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)
What people call “compromise” in politics is really just selling out on one’s principles.	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)
Interest groups have too much influence over political decisions.	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)

[4] Statements in this question are presented to participants in a randomized order.

BLOCK 7: WORLDVIEWS AND GENERAL ATTITUDES

Q30. Do you identify to a religion or religious denomination (if not, please select atheist / non-believer)?

( ) Muslim
( ) Christian
( ) Jewish
( ) Atheist / Non-believer
( ) Other (please indicate): _____
( ) Don't know / prefer not to answer

Q31. Independently of whether you attend religious services or not, would you say you are:

( ) A religious person
( ) Not a religious person
( ) Don't know / prefer not to answer

Q32. Now we would like to know your opinion about the people from other countries who come to live in [country]. How would you evaluate the impact of these immigrants on the development of [country]?

Very negative impact										Very positive impact
(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)

Q33.[5] On a scale from 1 to 7, how much do you agree or disagree with each of the following statements:

	Totally disagree						Totally agree
Strong, tough government will harm our country.	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)
Being kind to loafers or criminals will only encourage them to take advantage of your weakness, so it's best to use a firm, tough hand when dealing with them.	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(6)	(7)
Our society does NOT need tougher government and stricter laws.	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(6)	(7)

[5] Statements in this question are presented to participants in a randomized order.

The facts on crime and the recent public disorders show we have to crack down harder on troublemakers if we are going preserve law and order.	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(6)	(7)
Our prisons are a shocking disgrace. Criminals are unfortunate people who deserve much better care, instead of so much punishment.	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(6)	(7)
The way things are going in this country, it's going to take a lot of "strong medicine" to straighten out the troublemakers, criminals, and perverts.	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(6)	(7)

BLOCK 8: CITIZENSHIP NORMS

Q34.[6] Some people say that the following things are important for being truly [country nationality]. Others say they are not important. How important do you think each of the following is to be a true [country nationality]:

	Not at all important					Very important
Understand the reasoning of people with other opinions.	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)
Speak [national official language].	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)
Feel [country nationality].	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)

[6] Statements in this question are presented to participants in a randomized order.

BLOCK 9: COGNITION AND SELF-ESTEEM

We will now ask you some self-reflection questions. It is preferable that you answer these questions rapidly rather than slowly. Do not stay stuck on any given question, your first feeling is generally best.

Q35. If you're running a race and you pass the person in second place, what place are you in?
(write-in answer)

Q36. A farmer had 15 sheep and all but 8 died. How many are left?
(write-in answer)

Q37. Emily's father has three daughters. The first two are named April and May. What is the third daughter's name?
(write-in answer)

Q38.[7] How much do you agree or disagree with the following statements:

	Completely disagree					Completely agree
I don't like situations that are uncertain.	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)
I dislike questions which could be answered in many different ways.	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)
I find that a well-ordered life with regular hours suits my temperament.	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)
I feel uncomfortable when I don't understand the reason why an event occurred in my life.	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)
I feel irritated when one person disagrees with what everyone else in a group believes.	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)
I don't like to go into a situation without knowing what I can expect from it.	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)
When I have made a decision, I feel relieved.	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)
When I am confronted with a problem, I'm dying to reach a solution very quickly.	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)

[7] Statements in this question are presented to participants in a randomized order.

I would quickly become impatient and irritated if I would not find a solution to a problem immediately.	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)
I don't like to be with people who are capable of unexpected actions.	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)
I dislike it when a person's statement could mean many different things.	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)
I find that establishing a consistent routine enables me to enjoy life more.	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)
I enjoy having a clear and structured mode of life.	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)
I do not usually consult many different opinions before forming my own view.	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)
I dislike unpredictable situations.	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)

Q39.[8] Please read each statement and record a number 0, 1, 2 or 3 which indicates how much the statement applied to you over the past two weeks. There are no right or wrong answers. Do not spend too much time on any one statement.

	Does not apply to me			Applies to me
I feel that I am a person of worth, at least on an equal plane with others.	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)
I feel that I have a number of good qualities.	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)
All in all, I am inclined to feel that I am a failure.	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)
I am able to do things as well as most people.	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)
I feel I do not have much to be proud of.	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)
I take a positive attitude towards myself.	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)
On the whole, I am satisfied with myself.	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)

[8] Statements in this question are presented to participants in a randomized order.

I wish I could have more respect for myself.	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)
I certainly feel useless at times.	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)
At times I think that I am not good at all.	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)

BLOCK 10: CONSPIRATORIAL BELIEFS

Q40.[9] There is often debate about whether or not the public is told the whole truth about various important issues. The following questions are designed to assess your beliefs about some of these subjects. Please indicate the degree to which you believe each statement is likely to be true on the corresponding scale.

	Definitely not true	Probably not true	Not sure / cannot decide	Probably true	Definitely true
The government is involved in the murder of innocent citizens and/or well-known public figures and keeps this a secret.	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
The power held by heads of state is second to that of small unknown groups who really control world politics.	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
Secret organizations communicate with extraterrestrials but keep this fact from the public.	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
The spread of certain viruses and/or diseases is the result of the deliberate, concealed efforts of some organization.	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
Groups of scientists manipulate, fabricate, or suppress evidence in order to deceive the public.	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
The government permits or perpetrates acts of terrorism on its own soil, disguising its involvement.	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
A small, secret group of people is responsible for making all major world decisions, such as going to war.	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
Evidence of alien contact is being concealed from the public.	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)

[9] Statements in this question are presented to participants in a randomized order.

Technology with mind-control capacities is used on people without their knowledge.	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
The government uses people as patsies to hide its involvement in criminal activity.	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
Certain significant events have been the result of the activity of a small group who secretly manipulate world events.	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
Some UFO sightings and rumors are planned or staged in order to distract the public from real alien contact.	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
Experiments involving new drugs or technologies are routinely carried out on the public without their knowledge or consent.	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
A lot of important information is deliberately concealed from the public out of self-interest.	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)

BLOCK 11: CONSPIRACY THEORIES (COUNTRY-SPECIFIC)

Q41. Please refer to the codebook for the country-specific conspiracy questions.

BLOCK 12: CONSPIRACY MENTALITY SCALE[10]

Using the scales below, how much do you think that:

Q42. Many very important things happen in the world, which the public is never informed about.

Certainly not										Certain
(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)

Q43. Politicians usually do not tell us the true motives for their decisions.

Certainly not										Certain
(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)

Q44. Government agencies closely monitor all citizens.

Certainly not										Certain
(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)

Q45. Events which superficially seem to lack a connection are often the result of secret activities.

Certainly not										Certain
(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)

Q46. There are secret organizations that greatly influence political decisions.

Certainly not										Certain
(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)

[10] Questions in this block are presented to participants in a randomized order.

BLOCK 13: ACTIVISM AND RADICALISM INTENTIONS SCALE

Q47. On a scale from 0 (strongly disagree) to 10 (strongly agree), how much do you agree with the following statements:

I would join/belong to an organization that fights for my group's political and legal rights.	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)
I would donate money to an organization that fights for my group's political and legal rights.	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)
I would volunteer my time working (i.e., write petitions, distribute flyers, recruit people, etc.) for an organization that fights for my group's political and legal rights.	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)
I would travel for one hour to join in a public rally, protest, or demonstration in support of my group.	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)
I would continue to support an organization that fights for my group's political and legal rights even if the organization sometimes breaks the law.	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)
I would continue to support an organization that fights for my group's political and legal rights even if the organization sometimes resorts to violence.	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)
I would participate in a public protest against oppression of my group even if I thought the protest might turn violent.	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)
I would attack police or security forces if I saw them beating members of my group.	(0)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)